AI Career Pulse: Decoding the Job Market

Section 5: Story

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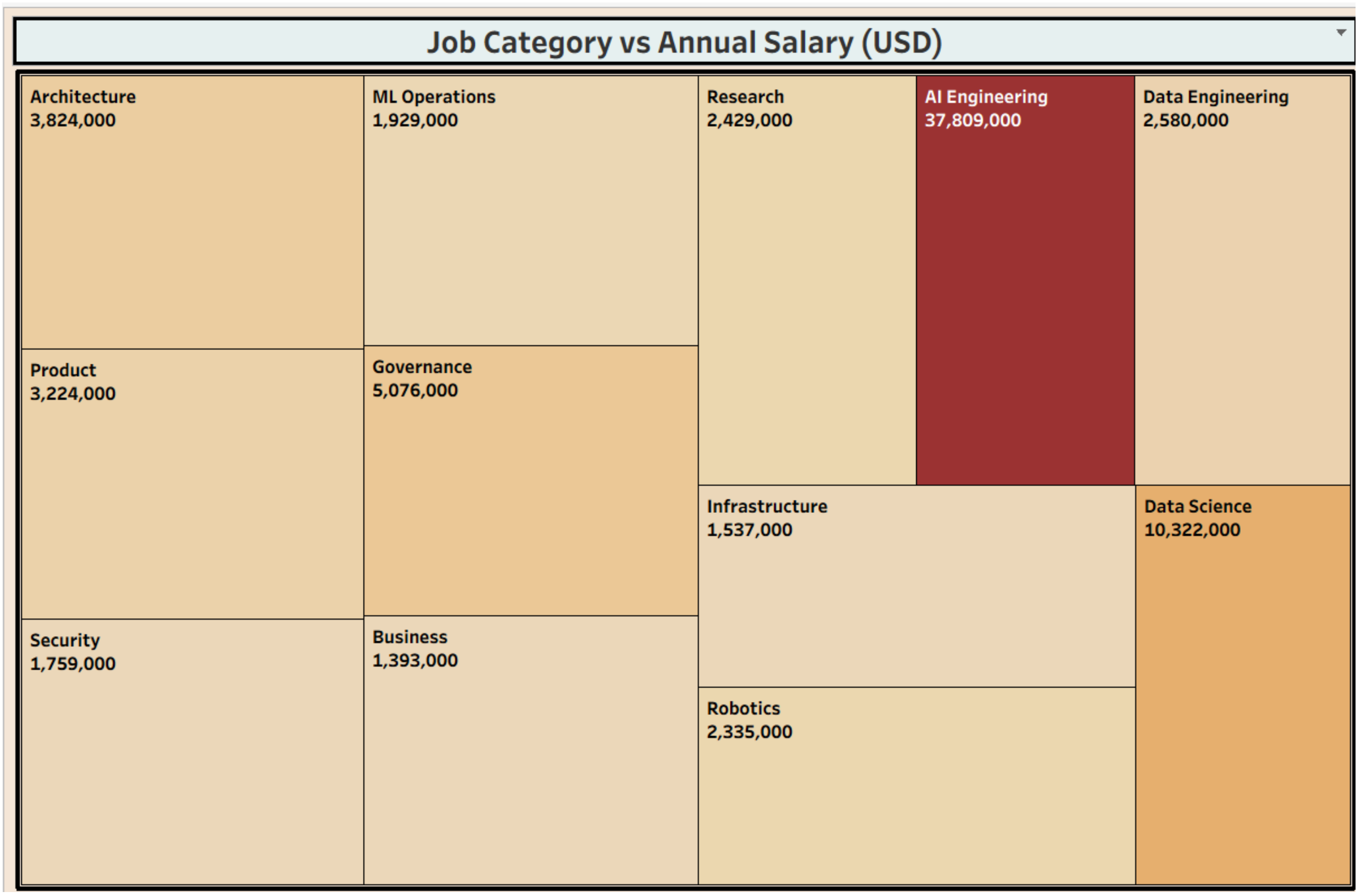
5. Story

Beyond the single-screen dashboard, a 5-page Tableau Story, "Deep Dive of Job Market (2025–2026)", was built to walk a viewer through the same data in a logical narrative sequence — starting broad (category-level totals) and progressively narrowing to a specific, surprising conclusion (experience vs. salary).

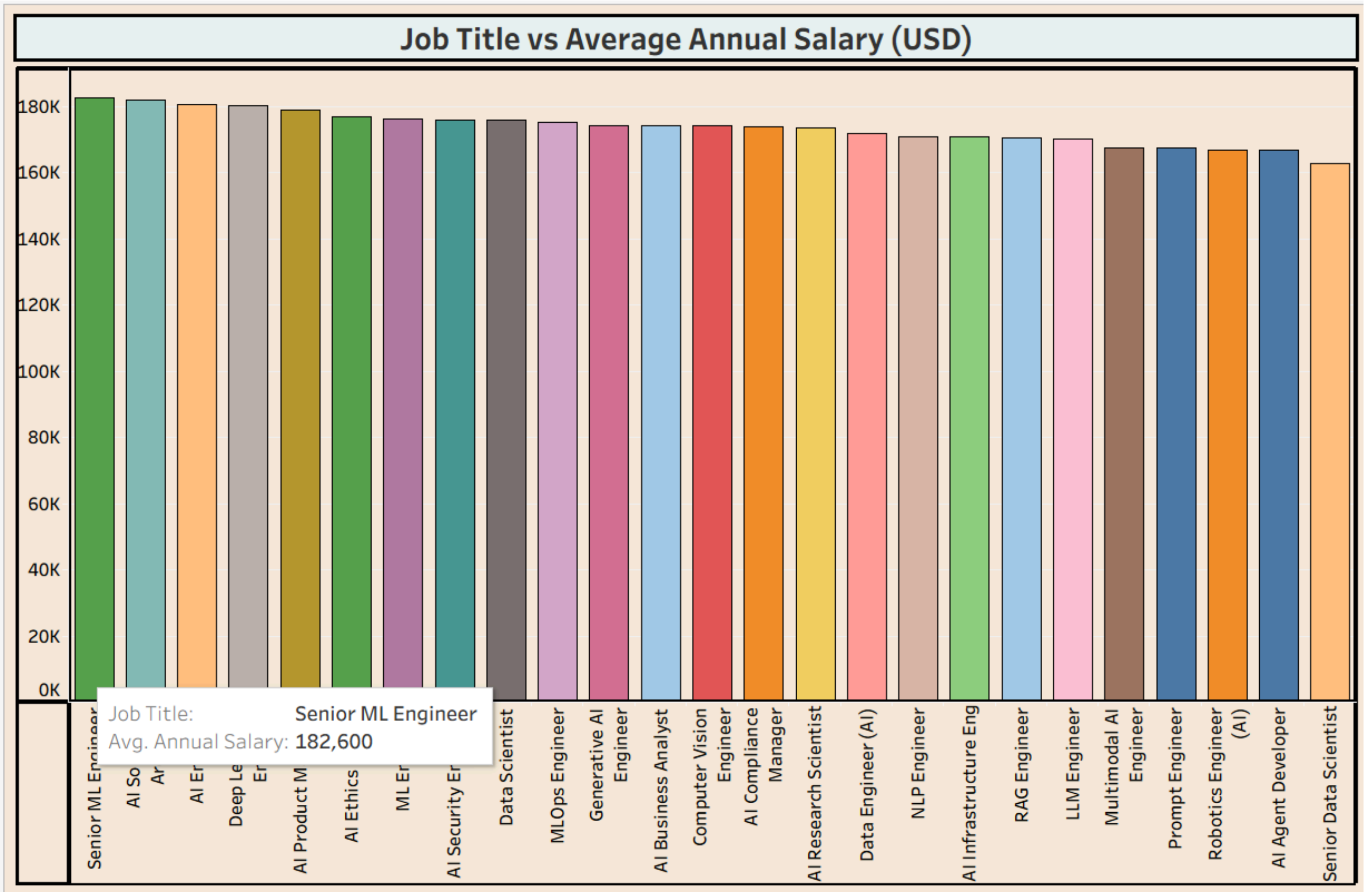
5.1 Story Page 1 — Job Category vs Annual Salary (USD)

A full-grid view of all 11 job categories sized/colored by total annual salary. AI Engineering (153,075,000) is the runaway leader — over 6x larger than the next highest category, Data Science (23,022,000). Governance (18,607,000), Product (13,620,000), and Architecture (13,082,000) form a clear second tier.



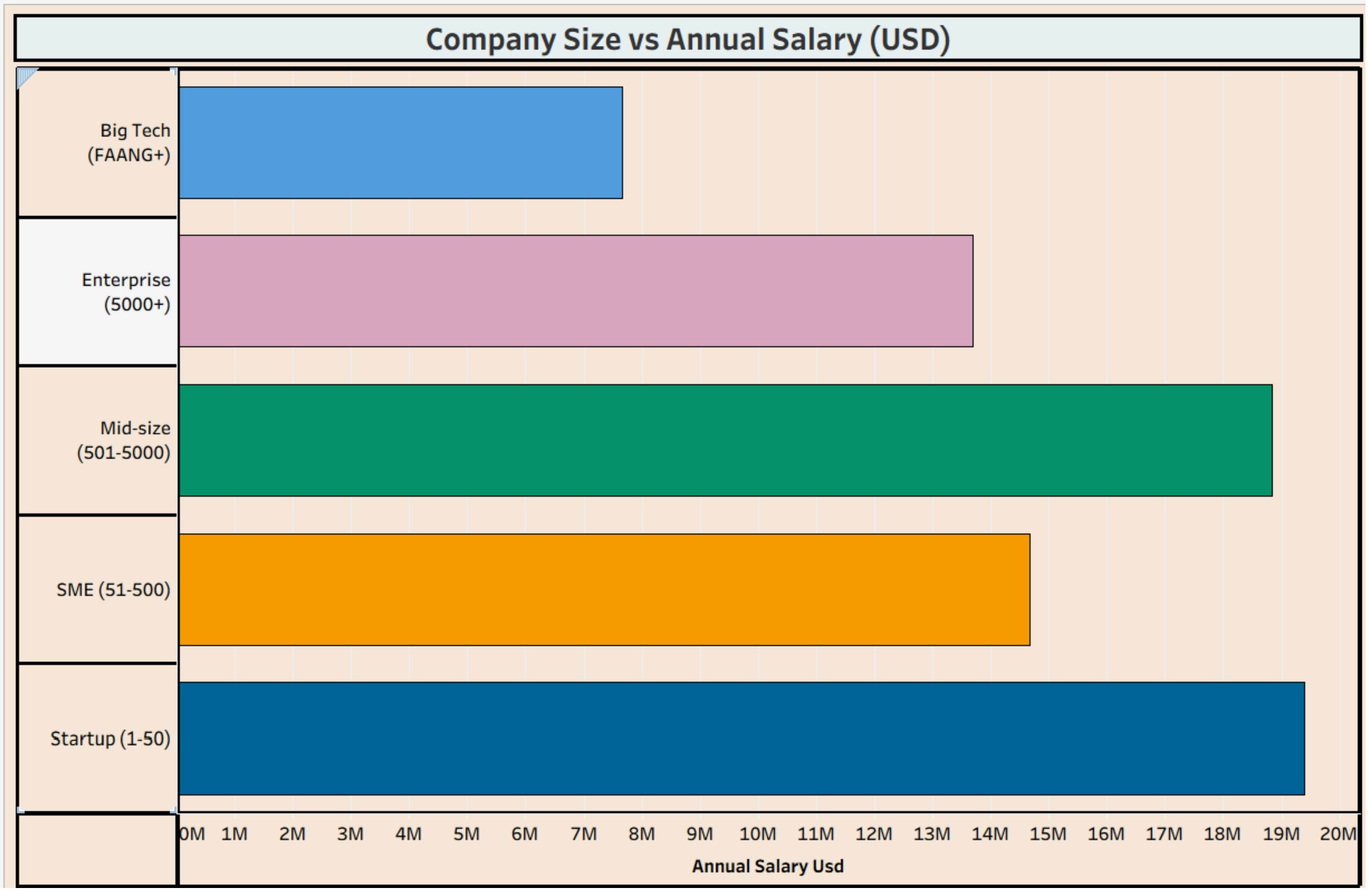
5.2 Story Page 2 — Job Title vs Average Annual Salary (USD)

A 23-bar chart ranking every individual job title by average annual salary, led by Senior ML Engineer and AI Solutions Architect at the top of the visible range (~$180K), tapering down toward Computer Vision Engineer at the lower end of this view.



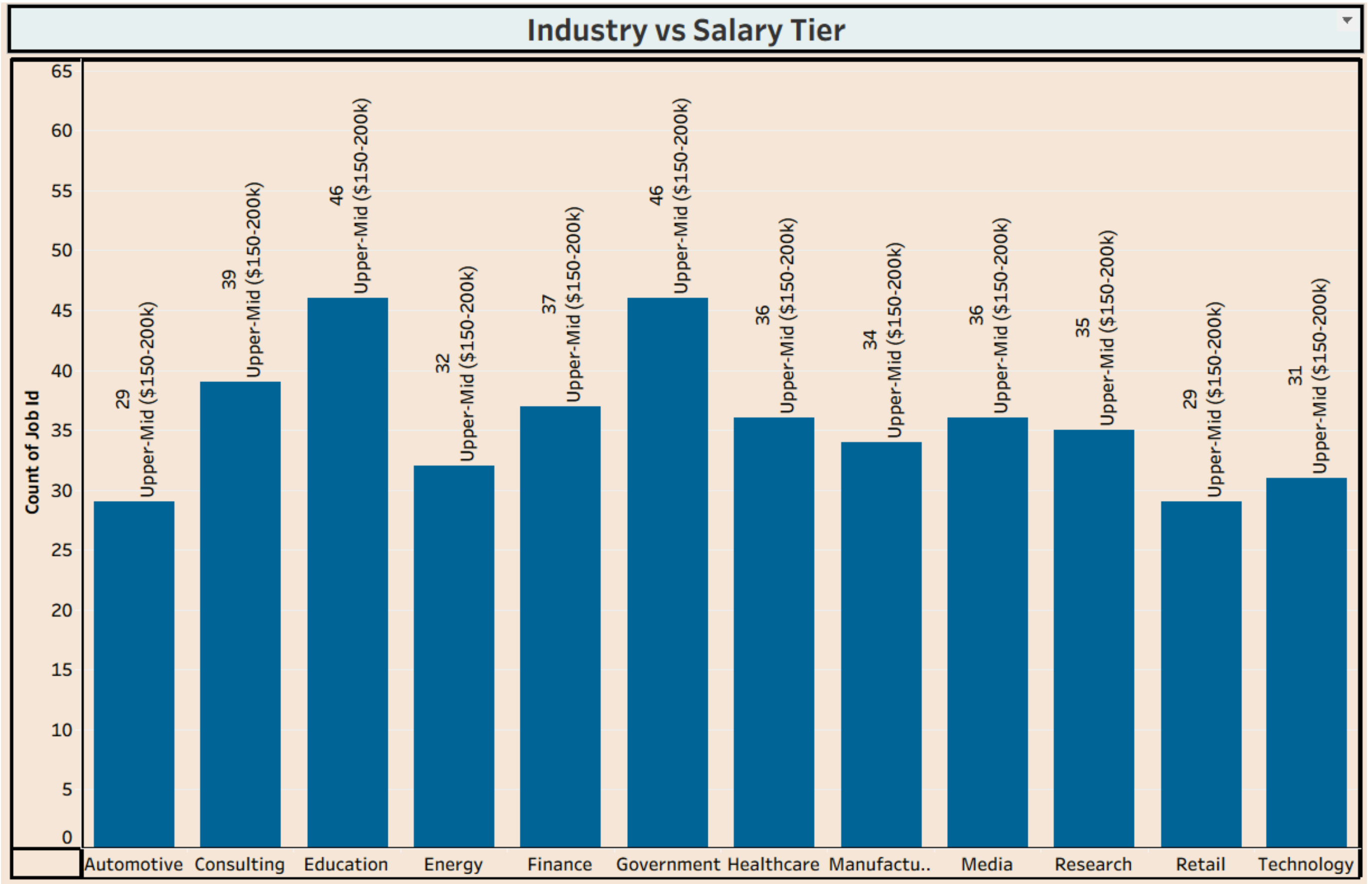
5.3 Story Page 3 — Company Size vs Annual Salary (USD)

Reiterates the dashboard's Company Size view within the story's narrative flow, reinforcing that Big Tech, Enterprise, Mid-size, SME, and Startup bands are all competitive on total salary — undermining the assumption that only large firms pay top-of-market AI salaries.



5.4 Story Page 4 — Industry vs Salary Tier

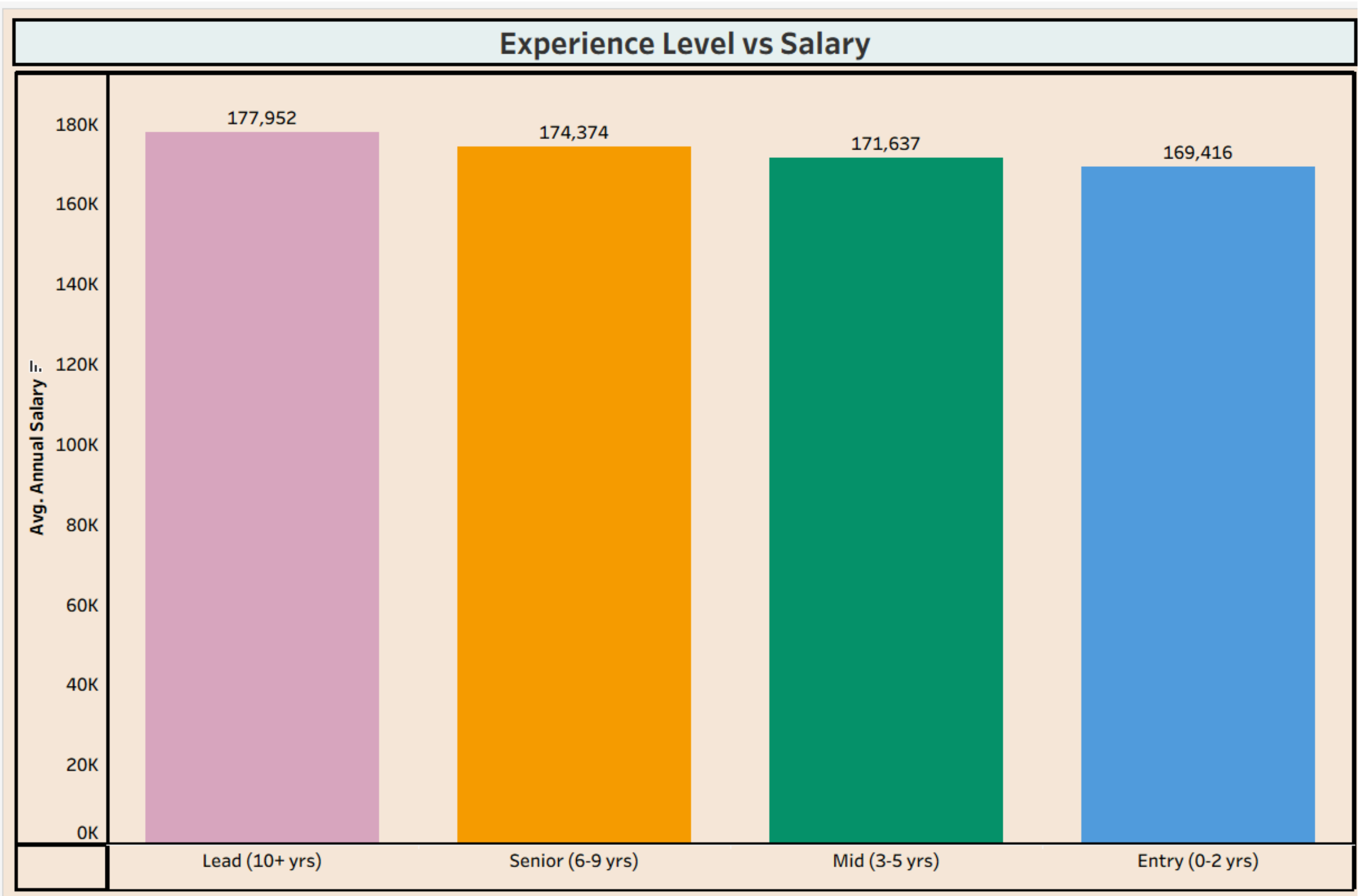
Repeats the Industry view with the same Top-5 focus, driving home the insight that Consulting (11), Government (10), and Research (9) are the leading industries for Upper-Mid-tier AI postings — ahead of the more "expected" Technology sector (4).



5.5 Story Page 5 — Experience Level vs Salary (Closing Insight)

The story's final and most important page: average annual salary by experience level — Senior (6–9 yrs): $172,214; Lead (10+ yrs): $171,071; Mid (3–5 yrs): $170,474; Entry (0–2 yrs): $166,167.

This is the story's key "punchline": the spread between the highest-paid tier (Senior) and the lowest-paid tier (Entry) is only about $6,047 — roughly a 3.5% difference. In a typical labor market, 10+ years of extra experience would command a far larger premium. Here, it barely matters, implying that AI-specific skills and role type — not tenure — are the primary drivers of compensation in this market.



5.6 Key Takeaways from the Story

- AI Engineering is the single most valuable job category by total posted salary.
- Company size does not strongly predict compensation — startups are competitive with Big Tech.
- Consulting and Government are underrated, high-volume AI employers, ahead of Technology.
- Experience level has minimal impact on average salary — this is a skills-driven, not tenure-driven, market.
- Hiring volume grew ~53% year-over-year (36 → 55 postings), signaling continued market expansion.

5.7 Stakeholder-Specific Takeaways

Stakeholder	Actionable Takeaway
Job Seeker	Prioritize AI Engineering / Generative AI skill tracks; don't overlook Consulting or Government employers; experience is a smaller barrier than expected.
Recruiter / HR	Benchmark AI Engineering roles near the top of the salary scale regardless of company size; expect competitive counter-offers even from startups.
Industry Analyst	Track Consulting and Government sector AI hiring closely; monitor the flattening experience-salary curve as a potential market-maturity signal.

5.8 Why a Story, in Addition to a Dashboard

The Dashboard and the Story serve two different purposes. The Dashboard is built for self-service exploration — a viewer can apply filters and jump between tiles in any order to answer their own specific question. The Story, by contrast, is built for guided presentation — it fixes a single, deliberate viewing order so that a presenter can build an argument step by step, ending on the most surprising and memorable insight (the flat experience-salary curve on Page 5).

- Use the Dashboard when: presenting to a stakeholder who wants to self-serve or drill into their own scenario (e.g., a recruiter checking a specific country/education combination).
- Use the Story when: presenting to an audience for the first time, in a meeting, video walkthrough, or report, where a fixed narrative order builds understanding progressively.

5.9 Story Screenshot Checklist

Use this checklist to confirm every story page referenced above has a corresponding image inserted in place of its placeholder box:

- [ ] Story Page 1 — Job Category Grid
- [ ] Story Page 2 — Job Title Bar Chart
- [ ] Story Page 3 — Company Size Bar Chart
- [ ] Story Page 4 — Industry Bar Chart
- [ ] Story Page 5 — Experience Level vs Salary (Closing Slide)